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UAE Presidential Court

UAE, AZERBAIJAN PRESIDENTS DISCUSS WAYS TO STRENGTHEN TIES

■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Ilham Aliyev, President of Azerbaijan, yesterday discussed ways to strengthen bilateral relations in support of shared development as part of the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership between the two countries. Both sides reaffirmed their shared commitment to broadening cooperation, particularly in development, economy, investment, food security, renewable energy, sustainability, and other priority areas. The meeting was held against the backdrop of Aliyev's visit to the UAE, during which he attended the opening of Games of the Future Abu Dhabi 2025.

UAE needs 1.03 million more workers by 2030

UAE WORKFORCE TO GROW BY 12.1%, TECH JOBS UP 54%

DUBAI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

The UAE will need to add 1.03 million workers by 2030 as the economy expands and digital transformation accelerates across key sectors, according to Service-Now's Workforce Skills Forecast 2025, produced with Pearson.

This represents a 12.1 per cent increase in the human workforce, one of the highest percentage gains among markets studied and well above projected growth in the US at 2.1 per cent and India at 10.6 per cent.

The report finds that manufacturing, education, and retail will be among the main engines of job creation in the UAE, adding about 133,000, 78,000, and 60,000 new positions, respectively, by 2030.

Finance and health care

Finance is expected to generate more than 40,000 additional roles, while health care should add around 39,000, reflecting sustained investment in financial services and medical infrastructure.

On a relative basis, the fastest-growing sector is energy and utilities, projected to expand its workforce by 33 per cent, followed by education at

MAJOR SECTORS OF JOB CREATION

78,000

new positions in the education sector will be added by 2030

60,000

new positions will open up in the retail sector by 2030

Biggest job creator

Manufacturing will be the main engine of job creation in the UAE, adding about 133,000 new positions by 2030.

1 Fastest-growing sector:

Energy and utilities is projected to expand its workforce by 33 per cent.

2 Most in-demand tech role:

Search marketing strategists are forecast to see about 5,600 new positions.

31 per cent and manufacturing at 18 per cent.

The report also examines how agentic AI will reshape work, stating that efficiency gains will be outweighed by the demand for human talent.

In financial services, for example, the technology could perform work equivalent to 17,000 full-time employees, or about 6.6 per cent of the current workforce.

Yet, the sector is still expected to see a 26 per cent increase in jobs driven by economic growth and the need for staff who can enable and manage emerging technologies.

The need for new skills will

be most acute in technology roles. While the overall workforce is expected to grow by 12.1 per cent, demand for technology professionals is projected to rise by 54 per cent.

Tech roles currently account for about 169,000 of the UAE's 8.5 million jobs, and organisations are expected to require more than 91,000 additional technology specialists by 2030.

Among the most in-demand roles, search marketing strategists are forecast to see about 5,600 new positions, followed by roughly 4,200 additional computer programmers and 2,700 computer systems analysts.

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UAE announces new age cut-off for schools

The revised age cut-off is December 31 of the admission year instead of August 31

DUBAI

BY ANUPAM VARMA
News and Business Editor

The UAE has announced a new age cut-off for school admissions for year 2026-27. According to the Ministry of Education, the new official age cut-off is December 31 of the admission year, compared to August 31 earlier.

This applies to all schools and kindergartens that start in August or September. However, schools starting in April will continue using March 31 as the cut-off. It's important to note that the criteria only applies to new admissions, while current students are not affected, the Education, Human Development and Community Development Council said.

Age criteria

According to the council, the age criteria is as follows:

■ **For pre-K** — Foundation Stage 1 in British curriculum, Petite Section in French and Pre-KG in other international curricula — the age should be 3

years old by December 31 of the admission year.

■ **For KG1** — FS2 in British curriculum, Moyenne Section in French and KG1 in other curricula — the age should be 4 years old by December 31 of the admission year.

■ **For KG2** — Year 1 in British curricula, Grande Section in French and KG2 in other curricula — the age should be 5 years old by December 31 of the admission year.

■ **For Grade 1** — Year 2 in British curricula, Cours Préparatoire in French and Grade 1 in other curricula — the age should be 6 years old by December 31 of the admission year.

Placement for students transferring between schools, curricula (e.g., British, American, or other international systems), or those arriving from outside the UAE, will be based on the last successfully completed grade and academic progression, in line with approved grade equivalency procedures.

The updated policy is designed to ensure greater fairness and consistency in enrolment, facilitate smoother transitions between different curricula, and better match early education expectations to age-appropriate developmental stages.

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